

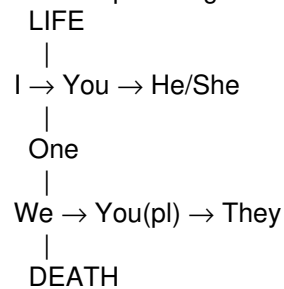
# Personal Pronouns as Topoi of Being

## A Logical Topology of the Subject from Life to Death

### 1. Introduction

Personal pronouns are not merely linguistic tools. They are ontological positions—topoi—within the spatial-temporal architecture of subjectivity. They encode transitions between self and other, between life and death, between the individual and the collective. This article proposes a topos-theoretic mapping of personal pronouns, crossing two fundamental axes: Life → Death and Individual → Collective.

### 2. The Topos Diagram of Pronouns



### 3. Ontological Interpretation of Each Pronoun

I — Origin of experience. Singular emergence. Living topos.  
You — Recognition of the Other. First displacement from self.  
He/She — Objectification. Narration. Distance.  
One — Ontological collapse. Generic or indeterminate subject.  
We — Communion. Inclusion. Expansion into collective space.  
You (plural) — Dialogic alterity. External address.  
They — Dissolution of identity. Distance or anonymity.  
Death — Null-space. Disappearance of subjectivity.

### 4. Morphisms Between Pronouns

I → You: Encounter. Entry into dialogical space.  
You → He/She: Projection. Externalization of the other.  
He/She → One: Collapse. Generalization or abstraction.  
One → We: Recovery of shared presence.  
We → You (pl): Outreach. Addressing the external.  
You (pl) → They: Withdrawal. Recognition without relation.  
They → Death: Anonymity. Fading from conscious space.

### 5. Collective Subsets: A Layered Topology

#### A. 'We' — Inclusive Collective

- We-intimate: family, love, shared body.
- We-experiential: small team, real-time community.
- We-symbolic: nation, ideology, belief systems.

Topos features: Continuity with 'I', high mutual resonance, reversible collapse.

#### B. 'You (plural)' — Addressed Collective

- Interlocutive You: direct dialogue with multiple persons.
- Functional You: institution, structured audience.
- Distal You: addressed yet emotionally distant entity.

Topos features: Discontinuity, role-based distance, potential for inclusion into 'We'.

#### C. 'They' — Absent or Dissolved Collective

- They-known: observable third group.
- They-anonymous: mass, abstracted presence.
- They-mythical: imagined, symbolic, ideological.

Topos features: Minimal mutuality, spectral presence, transitional space toward death-of-subject.

### 6. The Singular Collapse of 'One'

The pronoun 'One' functions as a quantum singularity—simultaneously individual and collective, neither anchored nor fully absent. It collapses all topoi into a probabilistic anonymity.